



# ELI — Simulations, Plots and Graphs (2D/3D/4D)

ELI v2.4.71

September 2026

## Contents

|                                                                  |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Simulations, dynamics, plots &amp; graphs — 2D, 3D and 4D</b> | <b>1</b> |
| How it works (so the claims are grounded, not magic)             | 1        |
| 2D — charts, graphs, plots                                       | 2        |
| 3D — surfaces, meshes, fields                                    | 2        |
| 4D — dynamics, animation, things that change over time           | 2        |
| What you get back                                                | 2        |
| Honest limits                                                    | 2        |
| One-line examples to try                                         | 3        |

## Simulations, dynamics, plots & graphs — 2D, 3D and 4D

ELI can **build things that compute and draw** — from a quick bar chart to a time-evolving physics simulation. It does this the honest way: it **writes the maths/simulation code, runs it in a sandbox, and gives you back the figure or animation** (fixing the code itself if it errors). Nothing is faked — if ELI shows you a plot, real code produced it on your machine.

---

## How it works (so the claims are grounded, not magic)

Three real pieces combine:

1. **The coding agent** (eli/coding/agent.py) — plans → writes → **runs** → tests → repairs. It doesn't hand you untested code; it executes it and checks the result.
2. **The sandbox** (eli/coding/sandbox.py) — runs that code in a clean temp directory with a **non-interactive matplotlib backend** already configured, so plots render headlessly and save to a file with no setup.
3. **The scientific stack** (the analysis extra, bundled in the installer): numpy, scipy, matplotlib (+ 3D via mpl\_toolkits.mplot3d), plotly, pandas, meshio. This is the ceiling of what ELI can build — and it's a high one: the same tools professional scientists and engineers use.

So “the most advanced simulations ELI can make” = **anything expressible in Python's scientific ecosystem**, written and run for you.

---

## 2D — charts, graphs, plots

Just describe it:

- “plot this data as a line chart” · “bar graph of these sales figures”
- “histogram of these values” · “scatter plot of x vs y with a trend line”
- “draw the function  $y = x^2 - 3x + 2$  from  $-5$  to  $5$ ”
- “heatmap of this matrix” · “pie chart of these percentages”

Backed by **matplotlib** (publication-quality static images) and **plotly** (interactive, zoomable HTML charts).

---

## 3D — surfaces, meshes, fields

- “show a 3D surface of  $z = \sin(x) \cdot \cos(y)$ ”
- “plot this point cloud in 3D” · “3D scatter of these coordinates”
- “render this STL/OBJ/VTK mesh and report its bounds, volume and triangle count” (via **meshio**)
- “draw a vector field” · “contour plot of this 2D function”

Backed by **mplot3d** (static 3D) and **plotly** (rotate/zoom in 3D).

---

## 4D — dynamics, animation, things that change over time

“4D” here means the **3 spatial dimensions plus time** — a simulation you can watch evolve. ELI writes the update loop, integrates the maths, and renders frames into an animation (GIF/MP4) or an interactive time-slider figure.

- **Physics:** “simulate a pendulum and animate it” · “model projectile motion with air resistance” · “animate a bouncing ball” · “double pendulum chaos”
- **Systems / ODEs:** “solve and plot the Lorenz attractor” · “simulate predator- prey (Lotka-Volterra) over time” · “integrate this differential equation” — powered by **scipy** solvers (`solve_ivp`, `odeint`).
- **Growth / agents:** “model a population growing logistically for 100 steps” · “cellular automaton — Game of Life, animated” · “random walk in 2D over time”.
- **Waves / fields:** “animate a wave propagating” · “heat diffusion across a plate over time” (a simple PDE on a grid).

Backed by **numpy** (the arrays/maths), **scipy** (the solvers — the “dynamics”), and **matplotlib.animation** / **plotly** (the moving picture).

---

## What you get back

- A **saved figure** (PNG for static, GIF/MP4 for animation, HTML for interactive) written to ELI’s artifacts, which ELI can open/show you.
  - The **code** it wrote, if you want to keep, tweak, or learn from it (open it in ELI’s built-in editor — see `blueprints/ide_guide.md`).
  - A plain-English summary of what the simulation shows.
- 

## Honest limits

- ELI is bounded by the **Python scientific stack** — extremely capable, but not a dedicated CFD/FEA suite or a game engine. For a heavy specialist simulation you’d still use purpose-built software; ELI covers the enormous middle ground of scientific/engineering plotting, dynamics and modelling.

- Very large simulations run as fast as **your** machine allows — they're computed locally, offline.
  - The scientific extras ship with the installer; from a source checkout, install them with `pip install -e "[analysis]"`.
- 

### One-line examples to try

```
plot y = sin(x)/x from -20 to 20
make a 3D surface plot of a gaussian bump
simulate and animate a simple pendulum
solve the Lorenz system and show the butterfly attractor
animate Conway's Game of Life on a 50x50 grid
load model.stl, render it, and tell me its dimensions
```